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Paystack Information Security Team
(Application Security Engineer — via Talent Safari)

Dear Paystack Security Team,

Re: Application for Application Security Engineer

I am applying for the Application Security Engineer role. I am a backend developer with about four years in production payments and billing environments where security testing is a release gate, not an afterthought — and I have deliberately built on that foundation to develop a security-engineering skillset.

Application security testing is my habit, not a task. At Benin Electrics (BEDC), I manually tested every API endpoint ahead of every release with Burp Suite and OWASP ZAP — probing authentication, authorization, and input handling — and remediated findings before they reached production, on a payments backend serving 325,000 customer accounts. At Chingu I repeated the same discipline on new builds: an AI trading dashboard that executes real trades, and a word game whose Supabase RPC endpoints and Node/Express API I tested with Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, and SQLMap for injection, broken access control, and auth-bypass.

I have shipped a real security fix in a security tool. I found and fixed CWE-614 in Tracecat, a 3.8k-star security-automation platform: the auth cookie's Secure flag was derived from the internal API URL instead of the public HTTPS URL, so it could transmit over plaintext HTTP. I shipped the fix with regression tests covering both cases, and a maintainer reviewed and merged it, crediting the find. That is the OWASP/CWE mindset working end-to-end: identify the class, root the cause, fix it properly, and prove it with tests.

I speak both languages — security and engineering. I work from OWASP Top 10 / CWE reference points and script security checks in Python and Bash. Because I also build and ship the backend (Python, PostgreSQL, Docker, GitHub Actions CI/CD), I can review code and explain a fix to a developer and to a non-technical stakeholder with equal clarity — and guide teams during sprints, not just report findings afterwards.

I am comfortable in a hybrid, distributed setup and genuinely excited about securing Paystack's fintech platform as it scales. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my background maps to your SDLC, vulnerability management, and DevSecOps initiatives.

Sincerely,

John Ezekiel

Encl.: CV (John_Ezekiel_CV_Paystack.pdf)